THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 10: **Indian Architecture** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why were Harappan wells built with wedge-shaped bricks? 1

(a) To decorate **(b)** To save bricks
(c) To resist the inward pressure of soil **(d)** To block water

2. A circumambulation path in a temple permits 1

(a) pradakshina **(b)** trade **(c)** feasting **(d)** war

3. Which of these is a courtyard feature that suits India's climate? 1

(a) air conditioning **(b)** shade and cross ventilation
(c) glass roof **(d)** thick curtain

4. Dholavira's use of stone is explained by 1

(a) religion **(b)** its location in rocky Kachchh
(c) foreign trade **(d)** lack of workers

5. What distinguishes the Dravidian vimana from the northern shikhara? 1

(a) Flat vs round
(b) Dome vs arch
(c) Nothing
(d) A stepped pyramidal tower vs curved tower

6. Chettinadu mansions were grand because 1

(a) merchants had wealth from trade **(b)** farmers built them
(c) forts needed them **(d)** kings built them

7. The toranas of Sanchi are important because 1

(a) they are forts
(b) they hold relics
(c) they carry sculpted stories of the Buddha's life and Jataka tales
(d) they are tombs

8. The terracotta temples of Bishnupur were built in brick because 1

(a) bricks were banned **(b)** stone was scarce in the alluvial region
(c) marble was cheap **(d)** they were forts

9. The Indo-Saracenic style arose in the 1

(a) Harappan period **(b)** Gupta period **(c)** Maurya period **(d)** colonial period

10. Why was the Buddha shown through symbols in early art? 1

(a) Law forbade it **(b)** Artists forgot him

(c) He was not yet depicted in human form **(d)** Symbols were cheaper

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Explain why Dholavira used stone. 2

12. Why is a temple tank important? 2

13. Why did Mughal rulers use red sandstone? 2

14. Why are Sanchi toranas important? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain why Harappan planning is called advanced. 3

16. Describe the symbolic meaning of the layout of a temple. 3

17. Describe how a traditional haveli suited its environment. 3

OR

Explain the importance of the Sanchi Stupa for Buddhist devotees. 3

18. Explain how regional materials shaped temples. 3

OR

Explain the colonial style of architecture. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain how climate and materials influenced architecture across India. 5

OR

Explain the water systems of ancient and medieval India. 5

20. Compare Harappan and Mughal planning. 5

OR

Describe the evolution of mosques in India and the blending of styles. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND